

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The biggest U.S. banks** would be allowed to loosen their capital requirements under proposals aimed at easing rules imposed after the 2008 financial crisis. **A1**
- ◆ **Jeff Bezos is in** early talks to raise \$100 billion for a new fund that would buy manufacturing companies and seek to use AI to accelerate their path to automation. **A1**
- ◆ **Investor concern** about the direction of interest rates and attacks on Middle Eastern energy assets helped pull down the S&P 500 and Nasdaq by 0.3% and the Dow by 0.4%. **B1**
- ◆ **The slide in precious metals** prices from records accelerated, with gold and silver futures suffering some of their worst-ever daily declines. **B1**
- ◆ **Unilever, the maker of Dove** deodorant and Hellman's mayonnaise, is in talks to separate its food business and combine it with spice maker McCormick. **B1**
- ◆ **Regulators sharpened** their focus on Tesla's automated driving-assistance system after raising concerns about its ability to handle poor road conditions. **B1**
- ◆ **TV station owner** Nexstar said it closed its \$6.2 billion merger with rival Tegna, a deal that will create a broadcast television behemoth. **B1**
- ◆ **OpenAI is planning** to unify its ChatGPT app, coding platform Codex and browser into a desktop "superapp," a step to simplify the user experience. **B1**
- ◆ **ABC won't air the new season** of "The Bachelorette" after a video appeared to show the star behaving violently toward her former partner. **B4**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The U.S. and its allies** intensified the battle to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, sending low-flying attack jets over the sea lanes to blast Iranian naval vessels and Apache helicopters to shoot down Iranian drones, American military officials said. **A1, A5-7**
- ◆ **Trump's war with Iran** has put the U.S. on a collision course with some of its closest allies over one of the most audacious foreign-policy moves of his presidency. **A1**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is preparing to ask Congress for hundreds of billions of dollars to pay for its campaign against Iran, setting up a high-stakes fight in Congress. **A5**
- ◆ **Saudi Arabia is working** frantically to project how high oil prices might go if the war and its disruption of energy supplies doesn't end soon. **A7**
- ◆ **Nearly 1 in 10 people** who had Affordable Care Act plans last year dropped health insurance altogether, after premium costs rose sharply because of the expiration of federal subsidies. **A3**
- ◆ **Attorneys general** from New York and California are leading an alliance of states, counties and cities in an attempt to reinstate the legal foundation for federal greenhouse-gas-emissions regulation. **A3**
- ◆ **Ukraine's ability** to continue the fight with Russia was thrown into question after Hungary's prime minister refused to lift his veto on a loan of more than \$100 billion to Kyiv. **A8**
- ◆ **A federal panel** approved a commemorative gold coin with Trump on it, in what would be the rare step of putting a sitting president on U.S. money. **A3**

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Japan's Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi met with President Trump on Thursday. When asked by a reporter why the U.S. didn't notify allies before striking Iran, Trump referenced Pearl Harbor, saying, 'Who knows better about surprise than Japan?'

Trump's Iran War Frays Ties With Allies as Oil Prices Surge

Multiple countries offer assistance, but not on the scale White House wants

President Trump's war with Iran has put the U.S. on a collision course with some of its closest allies over one of the most audacious foreign-policy moves of his presidency. Longstanding allies weren't informed of the battle plans until hours before the first attack almost three weeks ago, and they have since been pub-

licly criticized by the president for not providing enough military help. Some offers have been rebuffed, and friendly capitals have been left guessing over the White House's plans to end the war and soothe energy markets. Trump has moved to allay anger among Arab countries, infuriated by Israeli and Iranian strikes on major energy facilities in the region. He claimed on Wednesday that he had no advance knowledge that Israel was going to attack Iran's largest gas field, after U.S. officials said he did. But

By Robbie Gramer, Daniel Michaels, Michael R. Gordon and Bojan Pancevski

he has spent much of the week lashing out at European allies, demanding they join a military escort mission through the Strait of Hormuz only to later say he didn't need their help. The week included two awkward encounters with foreign leaders in the Oval Office. On Tuesday, Ireland's leader, Micheál Martin, defended U.K. Prime Minister Keir Starmer

after Trump rebuked the British leader for not providing the U.S. more support on Iran. On Thursday, a reporter asked Trump why he didn't give allies advance notice of his decision to strike Iran while Trump met with Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi of Japan. "We wanted surprise. Who knows better about surprise than Japan?" Trump said, turning to Takaichi. "Why didn't you tell me about Pearl Harbor?" Oil prices have jumped more than 40%, to more than \$100 a barrel, since the war

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Cost of conflict Pentagon seeks \$200 billion to fund war. A5	Commerce woes WTO sees trade and growth slowing more sharply. A5	Infrastructure hits Energy strikes leave investors scrambling for data. A7	Oil prices Saudi Arabia fears cost could spike to \$180 a barrel. A7	Markets Mideast attacks, inflation worries weigh on stocks. B1
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Bezos Seeks \$100 Billion For AI Fund To Escalate Automation

Jeff Bezos is in talks to raise \$100 billion for a fund that would buy up manufacturing companies and seek to use AI technology to accelerate their path to automation.

By Berber Jin, Dana Mattioli, Alexander Saeedy and Raffaele Huang

The Amazon.com founder is meeting with some of the world's largest asset managers to raise funding for the project. A few months ago, he traveled to the Middle East to discuss the fund with sovereign wealth representatives in the region. More recently, he went to Singapore to raise funding for the effort, people familiar with the matter said. The fund, described in investor documents as a "manufacturing transformation vehicle," is aiming to buy companies in industrial sectors such as chipmaking, defense and aerospace. It would dwarf the size of some of the world's largest buyout funds and rival SoftBank's \$100 billion, tech-focused Vision Fund. Bezos was recently appointed co-CEO of Project Prometheus, a new startup that is building artificial-intelligence models that can understand and simulate the physical world. Bezos plans to use the company's technology to boost the efficiency and profitability of businesses owned by the

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◆ **OpenAI 'superapp' to unify AI, Codex and browser.... B1**

INSIDE



MANSION
In Panama City Beach, it's goodbye, spring break parties, hello, luxury home sales. **M1**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Baseball steps into the prediction markets, strikes deal with Polymarket. **B1**

Suddenly Everyone Is a 'Builder,' Whatever That Means

Creating apps and websites used to be the rarefied world of tech developers. No more.

By KATHERINE BINDLEY

SAN FRANCISCO—During the tech boom of the 2010s, coding teams here spent months building apps that changed the way we live. Now, that's just a Saturday night for an 11-year-old. San Francisco has long been a city of builders, a label once largely reserved for developers in the tech industry. But thanks to advancements in artificial intelligence, a few well-crafted prompts in vibe-coding programs like Claude Code and Replit are all you need to create your own apps, websites and AI agents that can automate aspects of your workflow. Poof! Now everyone's a

builder: marketers, product managers, people working in the construction industry, tweens. The term is appearing in profiles all over LinkedIn and in social-media posts. Claude and Replit have seen their global monthly average user counts surge. "Every single person and their mama is a builder," says Willis Clayton-Stankowski, 25, who lives in Oakland. "I'm still not entirely sure what that means." Clayton-Stankowski was until recently a project engineer at a Bay Area construction company. Surrounded by friends who work in tech—many using automated coding programs—he started thinking

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Fed Plans to Ease Rules for Big Banks

By DYLAN TOKAR

The U.S.'s biggest banks would be allowed to hold billions of dollars less in capital on their books under proposals unveiled on Thursday, easing rules that were meant to help shield against meltdowns after the 2008 financial crisis. The proposals introduced by the Federal Reserve and other regulators would hand a major victory to big banks, which resisted sharply higher requirements proposed under the Biden administration. Wall Street's embrace of a second Trump administration largely centered on the prospect that

plans for stricter requirements would be scrapped. "An important benefit of these proposals is that they would reduce incentives for traditional lending activities—like mortgage origination, mortgage servicing, and lending to businesses—to migrate outside of the regulated banking sector," said Michelle Bowman, whom President Trump appointed as Fed vice chair for supervision. Big banks received bailouts in the 2008-09 financial crisis, prompting policymakers to impose higher capital requirements and other tightened

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American Wins Top Drug Cartel Job

California-born stepson of late Mexican kingpin is protected by Constitution

TAPALPA, Mexico—An American citizen now appears to be in charge of Mexico's most powerful drug cartel, potentially complicating U.S. efforts to eradicate the narcotics trade here.

By José de Córdoba, Santiago Pérez and Steve Fisher

No sooner was slain kingpin Nemesio "El Mencho" Oseguera buried in a golden coffin in early March, serenaded by popular ballads and surrounded by carloads of floral displays, than his California-born stepson began ascending to the throne

of the Jalisco New Generation Cartel, Mexican and U.S. officials said. The rise of 41-year-old Juan Carlos Valencia González marks the formal crowning of the Valencia family dynasty from western Mexico at the head of the organization known for its paramilitary prowess and territorial conquest, these officials said. U.S. intelligence agencies may now face legal hurdles in directly targeting and collecting personal data on Valencia González because of his place of birth. That risks hindering a significant tactical

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